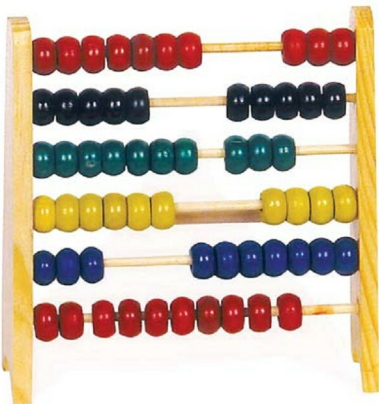


THE STREAMLINING OF COUNTING SYSTEMS

Let's make each of the five different counting systems unique in terms of audio-visual representation. This will help the visually challenged and hearing impaired to identify the numbers and the counting system that they belong to



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Mammoth debris was created in the hurricane development that spiraled computer science after the transistor was invented and developed, thereby bringing in sweeping changes and reductions in the size and power requirements of a computer. ICs followed transistors. These put the entire machine, which a quarter of a century or so before occupied rooms, on one's

lap. During these developmental activities, a dust was raised in applying binary, octal and hexadecimal numbers.

This article aims at standardisation in counting and making each counting system unique. This will help the differently abled—visually challenged and hearing impaired—identify the numbers and the counting system that they belong to.

Before achieving this standardisation, let me explain the various count-

ing systems in brief.

Different counting systems in use

Historically speaking, there have been only two counting systems. With the addition of three more counting systems (thanks to the advent of computers), these have been raised to five now:

1. Indian decimal system (IDS)
2. Roman system (RS)
3. Binary System (BS)
4. Octal system (OS)
5. Hexadecimal system (HdS)

Let us now take a brief look at each of these systems.

IDS. The most universal among counting systems is the IDS. It has overcome barriers like the language of a region and is the easiest understood of all. Some of its salient features are:

1. It has ten digits: 0, 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8 and 9
2. There are nine separate figures, one for each digit from 1 to 9. Each digit incremented by value '1.' There is this special figure '0' to represent the absence of any of these figures. Zero is the trump card of IDS
3. Higher orders of counting are done by simple permutation and combination of these digits in a systematic and hierarchically decided manner

4. When writing a number, say, greater than 9 by 1, we combine two digits: one to indicate that the digit representing ten's (whose degree is 1) is present and the other to indicate